



NACETEM

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NEWSLETTER

...advancing frontiers of knowledge in Technology Management

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From the DG/CEO's Desk

"We live in a society exquisitely dependent on science and technology, in which hardly anyone knows anything about science and technology" – Carl Sagan

Science, technology and innovation is like a man's shadow that cannot be run away from. While science explains myths and mysteries, technology simplifies an otherwise complex task and innovation makes it readily useful and handy for man to enjoy and to utilise for socio-economic growth and development. In a world where man is constantly in search of meanings and explanations to the ever-changing dynamics of his or her daily realities, science, technology and innovation become the saving grace. It is however ironic that despite the fact that we live in a society



Engr. Prof. Okechukwu Ukwuoma
DG/CEO, NACETEM

exquisitely dependent on science, technology and innovation, majority hardly know anything about it! In fact, many have concluded that Nigeria is not doing anything or it is completely groping in the dark when it

comes to inventions, discoveries, innovations and ground-breaking contributions in science and technology. This may not be correct as a lot is happening within the STI space that all and sundry can deploy to revolutionise almost all facets of human endeavour!

For close to three decades and aggressively in recent times, the National Centre for Technology Management (NACETEM) has been at the forefront of propagating science, technology and innovation as a veritable tool for rapid economic development. In this edition of NACETEM Newsletter, we chronicle our efforts in this regard covering revitalisation of technical and vocational education, technology management activities, science, technology and innovation workshop, among others. The essence of this chronicle is to open the eyes of our various publics to the capabilities of STI to engender sustainable development, if deployed appropriately, by showcasing the Agency's strides within the STI space in the last quarter of 2021 and a glimpse into what to come in 2022.

As a knowledge support institution, this newsletter contains cutting-edge training activities which can help members of the society to harness and couple science, technology and innovation to development. These trainings are handled by seasoned and cerebral scholars who are in tune with the global best practices, and the various courses lined up in 2022 are taught using world-class facilities available at NACETEM. No doubt, this edition of NACETEM Newsletter is simply unputdownable! Happy reading!

Economic growth: Minister harps on implementation of policies



Hon. Muhammed H. Abdullahi

Minister of State for Science and Tech.

The Minister of State for Science and Technology, Mohammed Abdullahi, says it is not only formulation of policies but their

implementation is what drives economic growth.

Abdullahi said this at a workshop on Science, Technology and Innovation Management, with the theme "A Tool for Rapid Socio-Economic Development in Nigeria," organised by National Centre for Technology Management (NACETEM) in Abuja on 24th, Nov., 2021.

He noted that no nation became great without the instrumentality of Science, Technology and

Innovation (STI), as could be seen from...

<https://independent.ng/economic-growth-minister-harps-on-implementation-of-policies/>



Skill acquisition crucial in achieving sustainable devt- D-G

Skill acquisition crucial in achieving sustainable devt- D-G, Prof. Okechukwu Ukwuoma, Director General, National Centre for Technology Management (NACETEM), says there is no substitute to skill acquisition in achieving sustainable development in Nigeria.

Ukwuoma said this in his address at the two-day workshop on Revitalising Technical and Vocational Education for National Development in Enugu. He said NACETEM was resolute in

revamping technical and vocational education in the six geo-political zones of the country as an attempt to complement the efforts of the federal government in providing gainful employment.

Science and technology education is a means of tackling unemployment in Nigeria- Kama



Mr. Obi Kama

Commissioner, Enugu State Ministry of Science and Technology

Mr Obi Kama, Commissioner, Enugu state Ministry of Science and Technology, in his address, at the workshop on Revitalising Technical and Vocational Education for National Development, organised by NACETEM, said one of the means of tackling unemployment in the country was science and technology education.

"The solution is to get abreast of the Technical and Vocational Training varieties available in contemporary technical and vocational skills acquisition programmes.

"This is the way to go in salvaging the youth from mass unemployment which is achievable existing curriculum in schools toward emphasising the inculcating of these trades and skills for self-reliance."

<https://nnn.ng/skill-acquisition-crucial/>

According to him, the agency is intentionally deploying technical and vocational education in order to ameliorate the challenge of



unemployment in the country.

"Let me make it clear that no part of the country will be left out in ensuring that Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) takes its pride of place in the

How technology can be deployed to tackle insurgency, by NACETEM

The National Centre for Technology Management (NACETEM), an agency of the Federal Ministry of Science, Technology and Innovation, has said that energy sufficiency in Nigeria would be instrumental in addressing insurgency in the country.

Director-General/Chief Executive Officer of NACETEM, Prof. Okechukwu Ukwuoma, who spoke at the centre located at the Obafemi Awolowo University (OAU), Ile-Ife, while addressing newsmen on the preparedness of the centre to co-host the 2021 Global Sustainable Technology and Innovation Community Conference (G-STIC), said science and technology would only assist hugely in decimating insurgents if adequate energy is available.

Ukwuoma said the production of technological equipment that would be deployed in fighting insecurity could be produced by Nigerians if given the right motivation and resources.

He also stressed that lack of political will, motivation, enabling environment and inadequate energy, were part of the difficulties in the need to use science and technology to tackle insecurity in Nigeria.

"One of the problems we have is that energy generation, transmission and distribution level is very pathetic. Production of technological equipment, both computers and others, requires a lot of energy and if we don't have the energy to produce them, we are merely discussing them. If we continue to discuss

drive toward sustainable development.

"The significance of TVET cannot be overemphasised, hence the need to continuously engage it to drive development," the NACETEM boss said.

He noted that the focus of TVET on practical skills distinguished it as an education that not only prepared students for the global stage, but also fostered better relationships between all involved.

Ukwuoma said that toward this end, the agency had in the last six months organised

similar workshops in the Southwest, specifically in Ibadan, Oyo state.

He stated the objectives of the workshop to include discussing the challenges...

<https://nnn.ng/skill-acquisition-crucial/>

ideas without putting them into practical applications, we won't achieve anything.

"Nigerians outside are doing wonders. It doesn't mean Nigerians are not productive in the areas of science and technology. Nigerians are very good when they have what it requires; when they have the right motivation. When you tell people to do something, you give them the resources, support and protection. If there is a political will to say, I want Nigeria to develop something, give motivation, get people to do it, supervise them and give them everything they require. You can even isolate or imprison them and give them tasks, you will see that people want to make names and survive," he added.

He said G-STIC, with the theme: "Shaping a Post-Pandemic World: Real-life examples of technological solutions for the SDGs," is a world expo edition, which will take place in



Dubai, UAE and will focus on knowledge and technologies that are crucial to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)."

<https://guardian.ng/news/how-technology-can-be-deployed-to-tackle-insurgency-by-nacetem/>



Linear to circular economy: Waste to wealth

By Isaac Oluyi

There is cynicism in the land. Disillusionment and despondency seem to have replaced hope for many in the land.

For many, they cannot see light at the end of the nation's dark tunnel. It's all gloom and doom for them. They are simply pessimistic about everything Nigeria and Nigerian! Tell them Nigeria is a land that flows with milk and honey, they will simply shrug it off as a rant of a mad man! It's that bad! To a discerning mind, however, there are endless opportunities

in the land; opportunities that stem from diverse problems begging for solutions. Apparently, where there are problems there will be opportunities.

The circular economy is a goldmine, not yet fully tapped. As it is, we are still scratching it on the surface. It is one area that can be explored and taken advantage of using both low-end and high-end technologies. It is an economy that the army of unemployed youth can explore. Interactions with some current players within the space reveal that it is not too capital intensive, as what is discarded is what is being developed into a product of value. Water hyacinth, using pure water nylon,

bamboo, among others, are some of the wastes the amazing Nigerians we encountered turn into valuable products.



What exactly is a circular economy? It is important to put it in proper perspective for us to have a better understanding of its viability.

The import of the immense opportunities that are yet to be tapped into in Nigeria dawned on me a few weeks ago when I led a team of like minds to produce a documentary on 'From Linear to Circular Economy: Turning Waste to Wealth' to be showcased in Dubai, the United Arab Emirates later in the year with a view to attracting stakeholders and investors in science, technology, and innovation community.

<https://guardian.ng/opinion/linear-to-circular-economy-waste-to-wealth/>

Technical, Vocational, Entrepreneurship Training Panacea To Unemployment – Experts

Stakeholders in the education sector have said there was a need to scale up youth development through Technical, Vocational and Entrepreneurship Training (TVET) in a bid to tackle the unemployment menace in the country.

They said TVET plays a prominent role in the reduction of employment among the teeming youths and economic challenges currently bedevilling the country.

The experts stated these at a workshop on Revitalising Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) for National Development, organised by National Centre for Technology Management (NACETEM) on Wednesday.

Speaking at the opening of the workshop, Director-General, NACETEM, Professor Okechukwu Ukwuoma, explained that TVET...

<https://tribuneonline.ng/technical-vocational-entrepreneurship-training-panacea-to-unemployment-%E2%80%95-experts/>

NACETEM DG tasks workers on effective communication skills to fast-track service delivery

The Director-General of the National Center for Technology Management (NACETEM), Prof. Okechukwu Ukwuoma, has tasked workers with developing effective communication strategies to ensure the timely delivery of services to the public.



Ukwuoma said organizations must also have effective communication systems to generate support and enable key people in their vision and goals.

The CEO gave the advice Thursday at a three-day training on strategic communication and public speaking, held in Akure, Ondo state.

According to him, it is important for organizations to develop effective communication to ensure clarity of stated goals and to enable workers to provide effective services to meet the collective aspirations of organizations.

He argued that the communications failure was largely responsible for the low productivity.

"Public speaking in communication has played an important role in education, government, leadership and business.

"Words have the power to inform, persuade, educate and even entertain, and the spoken word can be even more powerful than the written word in the hands of the right speaker," he said.

The head of NACETEM said the training was organized to familiarize participants about the

need to be explicit in their presentations, in order to gain public support for government programs and policies.

"Whether as a small business owner, civil servant or civil servant, teacher, student or leader, strategic communication and public speaking are important," he said.

The CEO added that strategic communication and speech training should emphasize the importance of communication in the age of digital technology.

He said the training would critically evaluate topics such as clarifying public speaking,

effective communication for optimal results, strategic delivery when speaking in public, innovation and productivity management, among others.

"This training will improve the confidence of the participants, improve their investigative skills and deductive skills, as well as enhance their ability to advocate for significant causes on a personal and organizational level."

Mr. Ekpo Nta, president of the National Commission on Salaries, Income and Salaries, recognized the fruitful partnership between the commission and NACETEM.



"We have received state-of-the-art facilities and training opportunities for our NACETEM staff," said Nta.

He said the training was to develop the capacity of commission staff to function optimally.

**2022 NACETEM TRAINING PROGRAMMES FOR CAPACITY DEVELOPMENT**

PROGRAMMES/COURSES		OBJECTIVES	TARGET PARTICIPANTS
First Quarter (January – March, 2022)			
1.	Professional Masters (MTech) in Technology Management	To develop in participants a deep understanding of how S&T can be harnessed for economic development; help participants comprehend the roles of technology within the framework of business strategy and objectives; and develop skills to manage technological change in various sectors of the economy	Graduates/Middle-high level officers in MDAs/Universities, Polytechnics Colleges and Research Institutes
2.	Postgraduate Diploma (PGD) in Technology Management		
3.	Short-Term Course on Science Communication and Diplomacy for STI Policy Implementation	To develop the capacities of participants to communicate science effectively in real-world context and expose them to the essence of science diplomacy in foreign policy strategy, trends in S&T and international affairs.	Principal and Senior officers in Research institutes, practicing Scientists, Science graduates, Government officials, Diplomats, Academic/Researchers and Journalists/Media experts who are engaged in science and technology-related disciplines or managing international research projects in S&T.
4.	Short course on Managing Technology for Organizational Leadership	To expose participants to how technological change affects business environment, role of technology forecast and how to manage technology to achieve competitive edge and business leadership.	Management staff of private and public organizations, entrepreneurs, business managers and project/programme officers
Second Quarter (April – June, 2022)			
5.	Short-Term Course on Digital Marketing & Technological Entrepreneurship	To expose the participants to entrepreneurship opportunities available within the NIS.	SMEs and Entrepreneurs.
6.	Research Methods and Data Analysis	To expose participants to statistical strategies on data collection, data analysis and the use of statistical tools/packages such as SPSS, STATA etc.	Researchers, Students, Policy experts, Scientists and Project managers.
7.	Short-Term Course on Managing Occupational Health and Safety Risks in R&D Environment	To expose participants to hazard identification in workplace, safety management systems and how to manage risks.	Management staff of private and public institutions, R&D staff, safety officers and safety enthusiasts.
8.	Strategic Crime Mapping and Analysis for Sustainable Development	To build capacity in deploying new knowledge and technologies for crime prevention and reduction	Government and private security personnel, security officers of MDAs and other institutions.

PHOTO SPEAKS

DG/CEO, NACETEM, Engineer Professor Okechukwu Ukwuoma with Dr Dietrich Van Der Weken at 2021 G-STIC conference in Dubai



Group photograph after the opening ceremony at the National Workshop on STI Management in Abuja.



Head of HRM Department, Mr O.O. Ayeni and some members of staff of NACETEM during the tea break at the STI Management workshop in Abuja.



Mrs. Ademola-Ajibade R. delivering a lecture at the STI Management workshop in Abuja.



DG/CEO, NACETEM, Engineer Professor Okechukwu Ukwuoma, presenting certificate to one of the participants at a recent workshop organised by NACETEM.



Head ACTU, S.J. Lasisi, at STI Management workshop in Abuja